

3000 ▶ 2000 BCE

3000 BCE

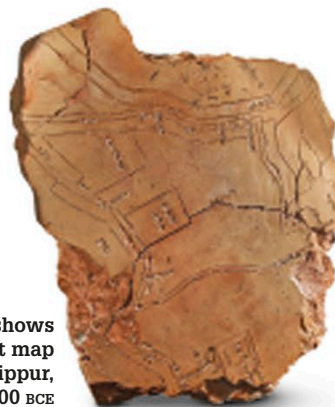
Standardized weights

As cities became larger, trading both locally and with other cities became more complex. Standardized weights were introduced in Mesopotamia (modern Iraq) to ensure that there was no cheating in the marketplace. These were based on grains of wheat or barley, which are all of similar weight.

Small model of an early Egyptian boat. The original was found buried near the Great Pyramid of Khufu.



Tablet shows street map of Nippur, c 1500 BCE



2500 BCE

First town map

The earliest known map was produced in Mesopotamia and shows a plot of land set between two hills. The clay tablet pictured here is the earliest street map. It shows the Sumerian town of Nippur, including the River Euphrates, the city walls, and a temple.

2500 BCE

Steering oars

Boats in Egypt were steered by an oar or a pair of oars attached to a vertical post. Later, the paired oars were connected by a bar, and the system developed into the rudder and the steering lever called the tiller.



3000

2800

2600



The Egyptians referred to the material called faience as “tjehnet,” which means dazzling.

2625 BCE

Step pyramid of Djoser

Early Egyptian tombs, called “mastabas,” were rectangular structures made of mud bricks. The tomb of Pharaoh Djoser (2630–2611 BCE) was constructed from a series of mastabas, one above the other, each smaller than the one below. This stepped structure was the first pyramid built in Egypt.

2500 BCE

Stones to Stonehenge

Neolithic people began to erect the central stone circle at Stonehenge (see pp.22–23) in southern Britain. This was probably a religious site connected with the passing of the seasons. Stonehenge had already been of some importance for several hundred years. Work had first started at the site around 3100 BCE with the erection of timber and stone posts within an earthwork ditch.

c 3000 BCE

Egyptian faience

The Egyptians perfected the technique of creating faience, a paste made of crushed silica and lime. Its attractive blue or turquoise colors are created by the addition of metal oxides to the paste. When heated, faience can be modeled like clay to make statuettes and other objects. It can also be applied on top of other materials as a glaze.



Ancient Egyptian faience bead necklace, 2000 BCE



Tomb of Pharaoh Djoser